

A 5.1 set of speakers



when you use the 5.1 mode, you have to sacrifice the Line In and the Microphone jacks for connecting the rear and the subwoofer connections. If you want to avoid sacrificing any of these connections then opt for a 5.1 PCI sound card.

The Creative Live 5.1 Value is available for Rs 3,000 or thereabouts, which is a very good buy. Higher end 7.1 sound cards cost a bomb while some motherboards such as the Intel 915G have onboard 7.1 integrated sound chips. Having a good sound card is important as it enhances the overall experience of watching a DVD on the PC.

On that account, to have a good movie experience you will also need good quality speakers. For watching a DVD, a 5.1 setup is a must since DVDs are encoded with 5.1 discrete channels of sound each emanating from a specified speaker according to the audio track. Newer movie titles come with 6.1 and 7.1 channels of audio, which can sometimes be overkill. A 5.1 setup is good enough for most movies; another use for the 5.1 speakers would be to playback DVD audio discs that offer more clarity and quality than regular audio CDs. However, for playing DVD audio discs you will need a 24-bit/96KHz sound card.